Daniel Okafor-Reyes

Backend Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 7 years of experience building and operating production services in Java and Kotlin, including Spring Boot microservices, REST APIs, PostgreSQL-backed systems and Kafka event workflows. Experienced in query performance improvements, automated testing, CI/CD, Docker and AWS deployments. Interested in moving into a Python-focused backend role; Python experience to date is limited to scripts and small Jenkins helpers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: Java (8–17), Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, Kotlin (basic), Python (scripting), Go (learning)

APIs and messaging: REST, OpenAPI, Kafka, RabbitMQ

Databases and performance: PostgreSQL, Oracle, Redis, JPA query tuning

Cloud and delivery: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, AWS (EKS, S3, SQS), Jenkins, Git, Linux

Testing: JUnit 5, Testcontainers, Spring Cloud Contract

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer | Tejo Insurance Tech | Lisbon | Jan 2022–Present

- Develop and maintain 7 Java 17 / Spring Boot microservices supporting policy quoting and claims intake.
- Designed and versioned an OpenAPI 3 REST API for partner quoting; onboarded 12 broker partners, handling around 400,000 quote requests per month.
- Added per-partner rate limiting and contract tests with Spring Cloud Contract for the quoting API.
- Implemented Kafka idempotent consumers and a transactional outbox for the claims workflow, reducing duplicate claim records from approximately 40 per week to zero over the following quarter.
- Improved quote endpoint p99 latency from 1.8 seconds to 450 milliseconds by adding Redis caching and resolving JPA N+1 queries.
- Deploy services to Kubernetes on AWS EKS using Helm charts and Jenkins pipelines; use AWS S3 and SQS in service work.
- Participate in a one-week-per-month on-call rotation; handled a significant Kafka lag incident in March 2024 and contributed a well-regarded incident write-up.
- Run the backend guild meeting every two weeks (since 2024).
- Built a small internal Kotlin / Spring Boot service to render policy PDFs from templates and wrote the team's Kotlin coding guidelines.

Software Developer | Viajar Online S.A. | Porto | Sep 2019–Dec 2021

- Built booking and payment features in a Java 11 / Spring MVC monolith backed by Oracle.
- Wrote integration tests with Testcontainers, increasing payments-module test coverage from 35% to 70%.
- Extracted email and SMS notifications from the booking monolith into a separate Spring Boot service using RabbitMQ and Thymeleaf.

Junior Developer (Internship, then Full-time) | CodeFarol Lda | Porto | Jul 2018–Aug 2019

- Maintained PHP and later Java applications for small business clients.

SELECTED PROJECT

OpenAPI Diff CLI | Personal learning project | Go

- Building a command-line tool to compare OpenAPI specifications; approximately 600 lines of code. Learning project, not production software.

EDUCATION

BSc Informatics Engineering | Atlantic Polytechnic Institute | 2018

CERTIFICATION

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 11 Developer | 2020

LANGUAGES

English (fluent; professional working language at Tejo Insurance Tech)
Portuguese (fluent)
Spanish (conversational)